

Analyzing the External Context of the Business-1

Analyzing the External Context of the Business-2

By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Demographic"

By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Economic"

What demographic segments exist in the population? Ans:

Is the market's economy strong or weak? Wh

How big is each segment and which ones are growing and shrinking?

Ans:

How is consumer confidence changing over time?

Ans:

How are particular segments different from others and how significant are these differences?

Ans:

What is the income dispersion in the marketplace? Which segments have enough purchasing power to purchase the product today and which are likely to in the future?

Ans:

Analyzing the External Context of the Business-3

Analyzing the External Context of the Business-4

By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Social and Business"

By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Government and Law"

Which ideas and business practices are current? How can laws and governmental practices enable growth or hinder the company's potential in various markets?
Ans:

Which of above these are likely to be prevailing trends and which are likely to fade away?

Ans:

What are the laws governing the industry and how do they impact the company?

Ans:

What is valued in the culture, current business environment the customer, client or enduser included in the target market?

Ans:

How active are consumers about their rights a

Analyzing the External Context of the Business-4

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By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Technology"

By analyzing the context you will be analyzing the external environments that impact your selected company. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Health and Environment"

How is technology changing the way consumers make decisions? How is technology changing the way consumers shop?

Ans:

How is the natural environment changing and what impact might that have on the company's operations and ability to source raw materials?

Ans:

How is technology or technology products changing consumers' perceptions, preferences and habits in the way consumers etc. live their daily lives?

Ans:

How does the product impact health and the natural environment?

Ans:

What new technologies are expected and how might they change the way business is conducted or marketplaces operate?

Ans:

How does the target market currently perceive the company and its products in relation to health and environmental issues?

Ans:

Learning from the Past

How can the Present be better Assessed?

By understanding how things have changed and how those changes affect the business so that the company can be ready to make adjustments to strategy. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Past"

By understanding how things are changing and how those changes are affecting the business so that the company can be ready to make adjustments to strategy. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Present"

What successes and failures has the company had?

Ans:

What consumer information is available that the company is not currently using to make decisions (online brand communities, consumer product ratings, consumer complaints, sales force input)?

Ans:

What can the company learn from these experiences?

Ans:

What companies within and outside the industry are succeeding and what are they doing well?

Ans:

None.

What best practices can be adopted from outside the industry?

Ans:

How can the Company be Ready for the Future?

Improving Business Model

By understanding how things will change and how those changes will affect the business so that the company can be ready to make adjustments to strategy. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Future"

By understanding how Business Model will improve and how those changes will affect the business so that the company can be ready to make adjustments to strategy. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Business Model"

What might happen in the future to the company, your customers, your partners or vendors, or your competitors?

Ans:

What fundamentally does the company do and how should it make money?

Ans:

What can the company do today to enhance its competitiveness for tomorrow?

Ans:

What is the engine that makes the business run? What should be done to keep the business growing into the future?

Ans:

Which emerging trends are other companies getting behind? What things is the company most dependent upon and what would happen to the company if these things disappeared?

Ans:

Improving Competitive Strategy

By understanding how Competitive Strategy will improve and how those changes will affect the business so that the company can be ready to revise and adjust its strategy. Answer the following questions (and include in your report in a paragraph form): "Competitive Strategy"

How should the company mainly compete?
By either 1.) having the lowest costs and thus being able to offer consumers the lowest price (Southwest Airlines)?, or 2.) offering unique, and superior performance on attributes or benefits that are valuable to a large part of the market (the superior shave offered by Gillette)?, or 3.) by focusing on a small segment/niche of the market and knowing it so well that the company can customize its products to meet the needs of its consumers in a superior way?

Ans:

Does the company have a cost advantage versus its competition? Does it have a product or service advantage versus its competition that provides you with superior differentiation? Does it have marketing advantages versus its competition, such as advertising efficiencies due to a larger market share, or a larger marketing budget? Does it already have an established brand with brand equity value? Does it already have existing relationships with its customers? Does it already have existing relationships with key suppliers/partners/vendors? Does it have superior research and development to keep a pipeline of new products flowing? Does it have better employees?

Ans:

